8 Projects (optional, for fun) FULL

Project 5. Weather and rain alerts for your garden

Quick version

No time to read it all? This is the short version. The full guide is below.

- Home Assistant sends your phone a message when frost or rain is coming. No hardware.
- Medium, 30 minutes, free. Do Project 3 first, with the phone app connected.
- Add the free weather source **Met.no**: Settings, Devices & Services, Add Integration. It needs no key.
- Frost alert: an automation at `18:00` that sends `Frost tonight. Cover tender plants.` when it is under 3 °C (37 °F).
- Test it: change the condition to `< 99`, press **Run actions**, then put it back.
- Make a Toggle helper called `Rain expected today`. Project 7 uses it to skip watering.

Level: medium. **Time:** 30 minutes. **Cost:** free. No hardware.

What you will build

Home Assistant reads the weather forecast and sends a message to your phone when frost is coming (cover the tender plants) or rain is coming (skip watering). This is the "brain" of the watering project later.

What you need first

- Project 3 done, with the phone app connected.

Steps

Part A. A weather source

1. **Settings, Devices & Services, Add Integration.** Search **Meteorologisk institutt (Met.no)**. Add it with your home's location. It is free and needs no key. (HA may already have added one called **Sun** or **Home**; that is fine. If Met.no is not offered, choose any free weather integration.)
2. Look at **Settings, Devices & Services, Entities** and search `weather.` *You should see:* an entity like `weather.forecast_home`.

Part B. A frost alert

3. **Create Automation.**
4. **Trigger:** Time, at `18:00`.
5. **Condition:** Template. Paste this (read it first; Gemini can explain it):

```
{{ state_attr('weather.forecast_home', 'temperature') | float(99) < 3 }}
```

It means "the current temperature is under 3 degrees Celsius". Use `Settings, System, General` to see if HA uses Celsius or Fahrenheit and change the number to match (3 °C is 37 °F). 6. **Action:** Notifications, **Send a notification via mobile_app_YOUR_PHONE.** Message: `Frost tonight. Cover tender plants.` 7. Save as `Frost alert`. 8. Test: edit the condition to `< 99`, press **Run actions**, then put it back.

Part C. A "rain is coming" flag

9. **Settings, Devices & Services, Helpers, Create Helper, Toggle.** Name it `Rain expected today`.

10. Make an automation: **Trigger:** every morning at `06:00`. **Action:** turn the helper on if the forecast says `rainy` or `pouring` (a **Choose** action with a **State** condition on `weather.forecast_home`), otherwise off. Ask Gemini: "Show me how to build this automation in the Home Assistant screen, step by step." Paste the entity names you see.

You will use `Rain expected today` in Project 7 to skip watering.

How you know it worked

- You receive the test frost message on your phone.
- The helper turns on when the forecast shows rain.

If something goes differently

What you see	What to do
No `weather.` entity	Part A did not finish. Add the integration again.
Template shows an error	Read the entity name in Entities and use that exactly.
No message arrives	Check the phone app is connected: **Settings, Companion app** on the phone.

Make it yours

- A heat alert at 95 °F / 35 °C.
- A message that says the 3-day forecast every morning.
- Compare HA's forecast with your own weather on the Data page of your site.

Next: Project 6: Soil sensor